

TWO FOR JOY

This London girl's got her moves in place. **Sabina Sheema**, 23, won the acting talent hunt *Zee Cinestars Ki Khoj*, but she had her eyes set on 70 mm. Now, she has signed not one, but two films. "I've always been a bit of an entertainer," says Sheema, who plays a dancer in her debut film, Anjum Rizvi's *Fast Forward*. Thanks to her twinkle toes, she didn't have to audition for her second film, *Nakshatra*. This one's stars are shining bright.



ROLE ROYALE

After donning royal robes in *Razia Sultan*, **Hema Malini** is travelling back in time after 25 years. The actor will be playing Vijayaraje Scindia, the Rajmata of Gwalior, in Gulbahar Singh's *Ek Thi Rani Aisi Bhi*. The film is based on the life of the queen and politician. While the Rajmata was a founding member of the BJP, the actor is an MP from the same party. Is this really a coincidence? "There were no political considerations. I may be a politician but I am also an actor," says Malini.



Sugar and Spice

The *Cheeni Kum* chase between **Amitabh Bachchan** and **Tabu** continues, as they play man and wife in Chandraprakash Dwivedi's *The Legend of Kunal*. The film has Bachchan playing the role of Emperor Ashoka while Tabu plays his fifth wife, Pishyarakshita. Arjun Rampal plays Tabu's stepson and the film deals with the sexual tension between him and Tabu. "Bachchan is the only actor who can play Ashoka, while Tabu is the only actor who can challenge his powerful screen presence," says Dwivedi. Truly power-packed.



Brand New Day

Unlike most rock bands that boast male lead vocalists, **Shibani Kashyap** has launched Sojourn, a five-member rock outfit that has her as lead singer and guitarist. "I wanted to make music that is far from the format of commercial viability," says Kashyap, adding that they soon plan to collaborate with international artistes. Sojourn has shows planned in most metros, but the one event they are looking forward to is in New York in January 2009. Hitting a high note, indeed.



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